LILALAND

A TRANSMEDIA STORY TOLD ACROSS FOUR MEDIA



INDIVIDUAL PROJECT

DIRECTION/
Visual Storytelling
Transmedia Design

ROLE/
Creative Director
Game · Comic · Character · App UI

COURSE/
UW COMMLD 534A
Visual Storytelling and Transmedia

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A girl looks for her cat. She finds her grandfather's sin.

“A narrative doesn't just stop; it spills into the audience's reality, blurring the lines between creator and consumer.”

Andrea Phillips, *A Creator's Guide to Transmedia Storytelling*

Lilaland is a transmedia story about **re-establishing the spiritual bond between humanity and nature**, told through a quest for a lost pet. I designed the world, the characters and every piece of media in it, and built the playable game that opens the story.



01 Theme

A cross-generational story of hubris and healing. Ten years ago a grandfather stole divine energy from the mountain to save his town and broke something that couldn't be fixed. Today his granddaughter follows a cat into the same forest, toward the disaster he left behind.

02 Audience

- Fantasy graphic novel fans
- Indie puzzle gamers
- Media omnivores

03 Objective

Turn passive content consumers into **active eco-participants**. Each medium reveals a piece of the story no other medium can tell, and together they close the loop the game deliberately leaves open, which can't be finished without stepping into real nature.

Two timelines, four characters

Every character carries part of the mystery, so meeting them in different media slowly fills in what happened on the mountain.

Dual-timeline plot

THE SURFACE NARRATIVE

Lila steps into a deadly ruin full of mutated plants and animals to find her cat, Sesame.

THE HIDDEN NARRATIVE

Her grandfather built machines here to forcibly extract divine energy, corrupting the forest and, in the end, himself.

A girl searches for her cat. She finds her grandfather's sin. And nature's final test.



Lila

The main character

Granted the butterflies' "void-solid reversal", she turns into a ghost to walk through earth, and uncovers her grandfather's secrets.

Sesame

The narrative catalyst

A (not so) ordinary black cat, sent by the forest deity as a lure and a witty examiner of whether Lila deserves the power.

Elias

The catastrophe maker

Lila's scientist grandfather. Harnessing the butterflies' energy to reshape his town, he triggered a catastrophe and locked himself away.

Azoni

The living ecosystem

The forest deity. Hidden in divinity, she sends the cat and grants the power that guides his bloodline toward redemption.

One locked door, four keys

The game ends at a door with no way in. Opening it takes every other medium: each gives the audience one piece of the code that none of the others can.



01 · THE HOOK

Game demo

MECHANIC

Void-solid reversal: become a ghost, walk through earth

LEAVES YOU WITH

A dying forest and a runic door that won't open



02 · PRIMARY MEDIUM

Comic book

MECHANIC

Dual-timeline storytelling

LEAVES YOU WITH

The grandfather's history, and a nursery rhyme that is the password



03 · TACTILE IMMERSION

Postcard

MECHANIC

Body-heat revelation: warm it with your hand

LEAVES YOU WITH

The schematic of the door lock: the scales and symbols broken in the game



04 · PARTICIPATION

ARG app

MECHANIC

Scan real plants to charge the grandfather's detector

LEAVES YOU WITH

His encrypted log: how the rhyme maps onto the lock symbols

DOOR UNLOCKED

Rhyme + schematic + log open the underground lab. The story only completes once the audience has gone outside and touched real nature.

A playable demo that refuses to end







A 2D puzzle-platformer I designed and built, **playable now on itch.io**.

How it plays

Touch a butterfly to become a ghost and walk through earth. Collect trash to restore the forest deity Azoni. Reach the summit to bring Sesame home.

Narrative value

Suspense. The ending is unresolved: a dying forest and a permanently locked runic door.

Why a game?

Games are the one medium where the audience actively chooses to be stuck. The frustration of a door you can't open drives the need for closure and sends players looking for answers in other media.

datepalm.itch.io/lilaland-jam

The comic carries the weight



Core mechanic

Dual-timeline storytelling. Lila's search runs on the surface; Elias's past shows through in the background, the margins and the rhyme.

Narrative value

It exposes the dark history of the mad scientist grandfather, and hides the literal nursery rhyme that becomes the password to the door.

My part

Story, panel layout and line art. Colour follows the two-timeline palette: mint and violet for Lila's present, plum and umber for Elias's past.

Why a comic?

Paper is best at carrying dense worldbuilding and a non-linear history. Only by reading slowly, physically, at your own pace does the story carry its weight.

A postcard you warm, an app you take outside





Tactile immersion: merch

Body-heat revelation. A thermochromic postcard: once warmed, it reveals the original schematic of the lab's door lock, with the scales and symbols that are broken in the game. Physical merch turns a virtual memory into something you hold.

Participation: ARG mobile app

Real-world flora scanning. Players scan living plants to recharge the grandfather's detector. When it reboots, his encrypted log maps the comic's rhyme to the lock symbols. It's the translator between paper and puzzle, and it gets players into real ecology.

Colour that tells you when you are

Two palettes split the timelines, so a glance at a panel, a level or a screen tells the audience whether they're in Lila's present or Elias's past.



LILA'S PRESENT

#78F5B8 #8B7CF0

Cool, luminous mint and violet for the search through today's forest: hope, growth, the butterflies' glow.



ELIAS'S PAST

#A666BC #925F42

Warm, dusty plum and umber for the grandfather's history: memory, machinery, the damage he did.

Flat indie ink

Clean outlines and flat fills that read at comic and sprite size alike.

Neon pop glow

The butterflies' divine energy glows against dark ground, in game and print.

Spatial continuity

Panels flow like a level map, so comic and game share one geography.

Seven months, one closing loop

The release is paced so each medium arrives when the audience needs the next piece, with the door opening only at the end.

Month 1–2

Seed the mystery

- Game goes live
- Kickstarter pre-launch
- App pre-registration opens

01

Month 3–5

Reveal the backstory

- Comic serializes
- Postcards ship to backers
- The passcode appears

02

Month 6–7

Close the loop

- App launches
- The door unlocks
- The story is complete

03

What I designed

The world, story and characters; the game design and build; the comic's line art; the ARG app's interface; the postcard; and this pitch, including a production plan, budget and Kickstarter goal for a small paid team, with all creative work staying in-house.

What I learned

Transmedia isn't the same story copied into more formats. The hard part was deciding what each medium is uniquely good at, then hiding exactly one key there, so that moving between them feels like solving something rather than reading a sequel.